

Will AI consume the entire world's water?

Posted by u/East_Rub_2104 • 0 points • 15 comments

AI uses water to cooldown its systems and it uses a ridiculously insane amount of water... will water become scarce and a more valuable resource?

Comments

u/asher030 • 1 points • 2025-10-16 02:22 UTC

...You know. if these companies were smart, they'd do an offshore rig for it, and couple it with a desalination plant. Cost offset by sales of seasalt and bottled distilled water. Heat's already being generated, USE it, increase efficiency. Why are they only using freshwater...

u/CarFreak777 • 1 points • 2025-10-15 19:32 UTC

No. There are so many humanitarian & environmental organizations and countries that would raise an alarm to really important people to allow such a thing to happen.

u/tulleoftheman • 1 points • 2025-10-15 18:51 UTC

Fresh water is already scarce and getting scarcer.

The water doesn't go away or anything, but its released into the atmosphere and will rain down mostly over the oceans. It takes a long time to refill freshwater aquifers and lakes naturally, and we are depleting them faster than they can replenish.

We could make salt water into fresh water to replace it (through distilling out the salt), but that requires energy, which today is mostly obtained through burning fossil fuels which pollutes the environment.

u/TeuthidTheSquid • 1 points • 2025-10-15 17:00 UTC

The only thing being added is heat energy, the water itself isn't being destroyed or used up. It's just dumped back out to cool down.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-15 16:58 UTC

[removed]

u/RuneanPrincess • 2 points • 2025-10-15 16:54 UTC

The water isn't consumed so no. Using something doesn't necessarily destroy it. Putting heat into water doesn't destroy it.

u/papuadn • 0 points • 2025-10-15 16:59 UTC

It does convert it into a non-drinkable form that likely needs to be treated again to become potable.

So it's an issue even if it's not literally destroyed.

u/capnwinky • 0 points • 2025-10-15 17:18 UTC

Also, no. I work in a data center that uses both evaporative cooling and closed loop. Evaporative is nothing more than a large ass HVAC, and the closed loop systems use a mix of 75% water and 25% propylene glycol. The latter of which isn't released. If it was, it still wouldn't be toxic because propylene glycol is GRAS and is in just about everything you eat and drink. Hell, you've most likely breathed it too if you've ever been in a hospital because it's used to purify ventilation systems.

u/papuadn • 1 points • 2025-10-15 19:04 UTC

Like I said, you can't drink water vapor and it's not likely to fall into a clean municipal water supply when it recondenses.

u/tulleoftheman • 1 points • 2025-10-15 18:46 UTC

Evaporative cooling converts fresh water to salt water, that is what this is referring to. Its released and mostly rains down into the oceans, depleting aquifers.

u/Due_Willingness1 • 2 points • 2025-10-15 16:53 UTC

I don't think so. Water that's used to cool something is usually still water when it's done, it'll make its way back into the natural cycle eventually

u/nefarious_indeed • 1 points • 2025-10-15 16:52 UTC

Eventually we may put the hugevai systems in space. Have computer cool from space, get power from the sun.

u/Jmaster570 • 1 points • 2025-10-15 17:01 UTC

Space is actually not good for cooling.

With no atmosphere heat has no medium to travel through.

u/nefarious_indeed • 1 points • 2025-10-15 17:03 UTC

What about the space elevator can we do it

u/nefarious_indeed • 1 points • 2025-10-15 17:02 UTC

Forever was the main complaint

u/Kitsune_Scribe • 1 points • 2025-10-15 16:56 UTC

So...Skynet?

u/nefarious_indeed • 1 points • 2025-10-15 17:00 UTC

No. Well maybe maybe maybe. At least with the software now we can pull the plug get them out there with unlimited power from the Sun I don't know

u/Deinosoar • 3 points • 2025-10-15 16:52 UTC

The water it uses doesn't really get used up. It ultimately turns into steam which then ultimately rains back down on the planet. The biggest issues are that they use fresh water but most of it ends up becoming salt water because most of it ends up raining in the ocean, and that they create all of that

waste heat in the first place. We can't completely stop creating waste heat but we shouldn't be doing it for completely unnecessary bullshit.

u/nefarious_indeed • 1 points • 2025-10-15 16:50 UTC

Not if it is recycled

u/Holiday_Display7969 • 4 points • 2025-10-15 16:50 UTC

No, but it definitely could be a factor.